



Mark Scheme (Results)

November 2025

Pearson Edexcel International GCSE in Business
4BS1/01

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General Marking Guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the first candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the last.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than penalised for omissions.
- Examiners should mark according to the mark scheme not according to their perception of where the grade boundaries may lie.
- There is no ceiling on achievement. All marks on the mark scheme should be used appropriately.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Examiners should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded and exemplification may be limited.
- When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the team leader must be consulted.
- Crossed out work should be marked UNLESS the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

Question Number	Which one of the following is a role within the marketing function?	Mark
	Answer	
1 (a) (i)	AO1 - 1 mark The only correct answer is C – Sales promotion A – is not the correct answer as workforce planning is a role within the human resources function B – is not the correct answer as quality control is a role within the production function D – is not the correct answer as training employees is a role in the human resources function	(1)

Question Number	Which one of the following is an example of a non-financial method of motivation?	Mark
	Answer	
1 (a)(ii)	AO1 - 1 mark The only correct answer is D – Job rotation A – is not the correct answer as a bonus is a financial method of motivation B – is not the correct answer as remuneration is a financial method of motivation C – is not the correct answer as fringe benefits are financial methods of motivation	(1)

Question Number	Which one of the following is a phase of the product life cycle?	Mark
	Answer	
1 (a) (iii)	AO1 - 1 mark The only correct answer is A – Introduction B – is not the correct answer as a cash cow is a phase of the Boston matrix C – is not the correct answer as a dog is a phase of the Boston matrix D – is not the correct answer as a star is a phase of the Boston matrix	(1)

Question Number	Which one of the following is an example of a public service provided by the government?	Mark
	Answer	
1 (a)(iv)	AO1 - 1 mark The only correct answer is B – Police force A - is not the correct answer as a clothing retailer is not a public service C – is not the correct answer as a mobile phone provider is not a public service D – is not the correct answer as a grocery store is not a public service	(1)

Question Number	Which one of the following is the interest charged by the bank on an overdraft of €1 400?	Mark
	Answer	
1 (a)(v)	AO1 - 1 mark The only correct answer is B – €168 A – is not the correct answer as €140 is 10% of €1 400 C – is not the correct answer as €1 388 is €1 400 minus 12 D – is not the correct answer as €1 568 is €1 400 plus 12%	(1)

Question Number	Which one of the following is the percentage change in the total costs between 2022 and 2023	Mark
	Answer	
1 (a) (vi)	AO2 - 1 mark The only correct answer is C – 10.53% A – is not the correct answer as 0.90% is $380\,000/420\,000$ B – is not the correct answer as 9.52% is $40\,000/420\,000 \times 100$ D – is not the correct answer as 90.48% is $380\,000/420\,000 \times 100$	(1)

Question Number	Define the term primary sector .	Mark
	Answer	
1 (b)	AO1 - 1 mark Award 1 mark for a correct definition of primary sector . Businesses involved in the extraction of raw materials	(1)

Question Number	Define the term shareholder . Answer	Mark
1 (c)	A01 - 1 mark Award 1 mark for a correct definition of a shareholder . • Anyone who buys a share in a business (1)	(1)

Question Number	State one benefit to <i>Ocean Vibes</i> of using competition pricing. Answer	Mark
1 (d)	A02 - 1 mark Award 1 mark for a benefit to <i>Ocean Vibes</i> of using competition pricing. • <i>Ocean Vibes</i> may attract sales from other boat tour businesses (1) NB Do not accept a benefit that is not in the context of <i>Ocean Vibes</i> Accept any other appropriate response.	(1)

Question Number	Calculate the price of the boat tour in UK pounds (£). You are advised to show your working. Answer	Mark
1 (e)	A02 - 2 marks Award 2 marks for the correct answer. £57 (2) OR Award 1 mark for working 60 x 0.95 (1)	(2)

Question Number	Explain one advantage to an individual of being a sole trader.	Mark
1 (f)	Answer A01 - 3 marks Award 1 mark for an advantage to an individual of being a sole trader plus 2 further marks for explaining the advantage for a maximum of 3 marks. • The individual has complete control over the business (1) as they make all the decisions for the business (1) therefore decisions for the business can be made quickly (1) • The individual keeps all the profits (1) as they have no partners/shareholders within the business (1) which means that they can increase their personal wealth (1) NB No marks are awarded for a definition. Answers that list three advantages to an individual of being a sole trader with no explanation will get a maximum of 1 mark. Accept any other appropriate response.	
		(3)

Question Number	Analyse why <i>Ocean Vibes</i> should measure employee satisfaction. Indicative content	Mark
1 (g)	AO2 = 3 marks AO3 = 3 marks <u>AO2</u> • Measuring employee satisfaction at <i>Ocean Vibes</i> will help it to retain its tour guides who operate the dolphin and bird tours • If employees at <i>Ocean Vibes</i> are satisfied, they will be motivated to provide good quality boat tours <u>AO3</u> • This will reduce recruitment and training costs for <i>Ocean Vibes</i> which may lead to higher levels of profitability • This may lead to good reviews from customers which may encourage good recommendation and increased sales	(6)

Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No Rewardable material.
Level 1	1-2	- Limited application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context (AO2). - Attempts to deconstruct business information and/or issues, finding limited connections between points (AO3).
Level 2	3-4	- Sound application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context although there may be some inconsistencies (AO2). - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding interconnected points with chains of reasoning, although there may be some logical inconsistencies (AO3).
Level 3	5-6	- Detailed application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context throughout (AO2). - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding detailed interconnected points with logical chains of reasoning (AO3).

Question Number	State one fixed cost <i>Ocean Vibes</i> is likely to pay. Answer	Mark
2 (a)	A02 - 1 mark Award 1 mark for a fixed costs that <i>Ocean Vibes</i> are likely to pay. • Wages/salaries paid to the tour guides (1) • Rent/fees paid to the tourist resort (1) NB Do not accept a reason that is not in the context of <i>Ocean Vibes</i> Accept any other appropriate response.	(1)

Question Number	State one method of primary research <i>Ocean Vibes</i> may use. Answer	Mark
2 (b)	A02 - 1 mark Award 1 mark for a method of primary research <i>Ocean Vibes</i> may use • Dolphin tour customer survey (1) • Scientist focus group (1) NB Do not accept a method that is not in the context of <i>Ocean Vibes</i> Accept any other appropriate response.	(1)

Question Number	Explain one advantage to a business of having high market share.	Mark
2 (c)	Answer	
	A01 - 3 marks Award 1 mark for one advantage to a business of having a high market share, plus 2 further marks for explaining the reason, for a maximum of 3 marks. • The business is likely to have loyal customers (1) as the business is performing better than competitors in terms of sales volume/revenue (1) leading to higher potential profitability (1) • Higher market share can generate higher sales (1) this would allow the business to benefit from economies of scale (1) reducing the total costs of the business (1) NB No marks are awarded for a definition. Answers that list three advantages of a business having a high market share with no explanation will get 1 mark only. Accept any other appropriate response.	

(3)

Question Number	Explain one advantage to a business of using e-commerce to sell its products. Answer	Mark
2 (d)	A01 - 3 marks Award 1 mark for an advantage to a business of using e-commerce to sell its products, plus 2 further marks for explaining this advantage, for a maximum of 3 marks. • A business may reduce its costs (1) as it may not have to pay for a retail store/office (1) leading to increased levels of profit for the business (1) • More customers will use an online business rather than going to a store (1) this will increase the revenue of the business (1) leading to increased market share (1) NB No marks are awarded for a definition. Answers that list three advantages of using e-commerce to sell its products with no explanation will get 1 mark only. Accept any other appropriate response.	(3)

Question Number	Explain one reason why shareholders would be interested in the financial documents of a business. Answer	Mark
2 (e)	A01 - 3 marks Award 1 mark for a reason why shareholders would be interested in the financial documents of a business, plus 2 further marks for explaining the reason, for a maximum of 3 marks. • Shareholders may review the financial documents to assess if the business is making a profit (1) as the shareholder is interested in gaining a return on their investment (1) which may help them to decide to either sell their shares or buy more shares in the business (1) • To compare the financial performance of the business (1) in order to identify cost savings (1) which can help to improve the profitability of the business (1) NB No marks are awarded for a definition. Answers that list three reasons why shareholders would be interested in the financial documents of a business, with no explanation will get a maximum of 1 mark Accept any other appropriate response.	(3)

Question Number	The owners of <i>Ocean Vibes</i> plan to grow the business. They are considering two options to finance the growth: Option 1: venture capital Option 2: loan capital. Justify which one of these two options the owners of <i>Ocean Vibes</i> should choose Indicative content	Mark
2 (f)	A02 = 3 marks A03 = 3 marks A04 = 3 marks <u>A02</u> • Option 1 – <i>Ocean Vibes</i> may appeal to an individual who wishes to invest in a business that is concerned with the welfare of birds and dolphins • Option 2 – <i>Ocean Vibes</i> could use a loan to buy new boats to enable it to offer more boat tours <u>A03</u> • Option 1 – The venture capitalist may offer advice to the young scientists to help them increase the revenue of <i>Ocean Vibes</i> • Option 2 – It is possible that a loan for a large amount of money can be received from the bank quickly to enable <i>Ocean Vibes</i> to buy new boats for its business <u>A04</u> • Option 1 – However, the venture capitalist may wish to take some control of the business which may cause disagreement within the business • Option 2 – However, interest will be paid on the loan in addition to the loan amount which will increase costs and possibly reduce profitability	(9)

Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No Rewardable material.
Level 1	1-3	• Limited application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context. (AO2) • Attempts to deconstruct business information and/or issues, finding limited connections between points. (AO3) • Makes a judgement, providing a simple justification based on limited evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)
Level 2	4-6	• Sound application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context, although there may be some inconsistencies. (AO2) • Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding interconnected points with chains of reasoning, although there may be some logical inconsistencies. (AO3) • Makes a judgement, providing a justification based on sound evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)
Level 3	7 - 9	• Detailed application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context throughout. (AO2) • Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding detailed interconnected points with logical chains of reasoning (AO3) • Makes a judgement, providing a clear justification based on a thorough evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)

Question Number	Define the term span of control .	Mark
	Answer	
3 (a)	A01 - 1 mark Award 1 mark for a correct definition of span of control. The number of workers/subordinates a person is directly responsible for/directly controls (1)	(1)

Question Number	Outline one way <i>Ocean Vibes</i> may promote its business.	Mark
	Answer	
3 (b)	A02 - 2 marks Award up to 2 marks for linked points outlining one way <i>Ocean Vibes</i> may promote its business. Award a maximum of 1 mark if points are not linked. <i>Ocean Vibes</i> could use a poster (1) to encourage visitors to book boat tours (1) <i>Ocean Vibes</i> could use social media (1) to help reach a wider audience of potential tourists (1) NB To award 2 marks there must be linked points and evidence of application. Accept any other appropriate response.	(2)

Question Number	Calculate the return on capital employed (ROCE). You are advised to show your working.	Mark
	Answer	
3 (c)	A02 - 2 marks Award 2 marks for the correct answer: 75% (2) OR Award 1 mark for working $60\,000 / 80\,000 \times 100$ (1)	(2)

Question Number	Analyse the advantages to <i>Ocean Vibes</i> of using on-the-job training for new workers.	Mark
	Indicative content	
3 (d)	A02 = 3 marks A03 = 3 marks <u>A02</u> - The new tour guides can learn from existing tours guides on the boats on how to provide its customers with an enjoyable boat tour - It will be less expensive for <i>Ocean Vibes</i> if the tour guides learn how to gather research on the wildlife from the existing guides rather than learning from an external business <u>A03</u> - This may lead to <i>Ocean Vibes</i> meeting the specific needs of its customers to provide excellent customer service - This will reduce training costs for <i>Ocean Vibes</i> and help improve its profitability	(6)

Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1-2	- Limited application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context (AO2). - Attempts to deconstruct business information and/or issues, finding limited connections between points (AO3).
Level 2	3-4	- Sound application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context, although there may be some inconsistencies. (AO2) - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding interconnected points with chains of reasoning, although there may be some logical inconsistencies. (AO3)
Level 3	5-6	- Detailed application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context throughout (AO2). - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding detailed interconnected points with logical chains of reasoning (AO3).

Question Number	Option 1: Employ part-time tour guides instead of full-time tour guides Option 2: Reduce the rate of commission paid to its sales team. Justify which one of these two options <i>Ocean Vibes</i> should choose to increase its profit. Indicative content	Mark
3 (e)	A02 = 3 marks A03 = 3 marks A04 = 3 marks <u>A02</u> • Option 1 – <i>Ocean Vibes</i> will be able to reduce the wages of the wildlife tour guides • Option 2 – Reducing commission from 5% lowers the total variable costs of the boat tours <u>A03</u> • Option 1 – This will reduce the fixed costs for <i>Ocean Vibes</i> as they will be paying less in salaries for its tour guides and therefore increasing profit • Option 2 – Assuming the sales team sell the same number of tours, this will increase the profit as cost of sales will be reduced <u>A04</u> • Option 1 – However, it is possible that part-time employees are less committed to the business if they prefer full time work, which may lead to tour guides leaving <i>Ocean Vibes</i> for alternative employment • Option 2 – However, the sales team may be less motivated to work which may lead to a reduction in the revenue and the profitability of boat tours for <i>Ocean Vibes</i>	(9)

Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1-3	- Limited application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context (AO2). - Attempts to deconstruct business information and/or issues, finding limited connections between points (AO3). - Makes a judgement, providing a simple justification based on limited evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made (AO4).
Level 2	4-6	- Sound application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context although there may be some inconsistencies (AO2). - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding interconnected points with chains of reasoning, although there may be some logical inconsistencies (AO3). - Makes a judgement, providing a justification based on sound evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made (AO4).
Level 3	7 - 9	- Detailed application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context throughout (AO2). - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding detailed interconnected points with logical chains of reasoning (AO3). - Makes a judgement, providing a clear justification based on a thorough evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made (AO4).

Question Number	Calculate, to two decimal places, the new monthly minimum wage after an increase of 3.6%. You are advised to show your working. Answer	Mark
4 (a)	A02 - 2 marks Award 2 marks for the correct answer €849.52 (2) Award 1 mark for working 820 x 3.6% (1) OR 29.52 (1)	(2)

Question Number	Analyse the importance of cash to the success of <i>Ocean Vibes</i> Indicative content	Mark
4 (b)	AO2 – 3 marks AO3 – 3 marks <u>AO2</u> • <i>Ocean Vibes</i> requires cash to pay the wages and salaries of its boat tour guides and sales team • <i>Ocean Vibes</i> need cash to pay its overheads such as fuel and other equipment for the boat <u>AO3</u> • If <i>Ocean Vibes</i> is unable to pay the wages of the tour guides on time, the guides are likely to leave the business to work for a competitor • If <i>Ocean Vibes</i> runs out of cash and is unable to pay its liabilities, then the business may become insolvent and close down	(6)

Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1-2	- Limited application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context. (AO2) - Attempts to deconstruct business information and/or issues, finding limited connections between points. (AO3)
Level 2	3-4	- Sound application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context although there may be some inconsistencies. (AO2) - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding interconnected points with chains of reasoning, although there may be some logical inconsistencies. (AO3)
Level 3	5-6	- Detailed application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context throughout. (AO2) - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding detailed interconnected points with logical chains of reasoning. (AO3)

Question Number	Evaluate the benefits to <i>Ocean Vibes</i> of operating as a franchise to further expand its business. You should use the information provided as well as your own knowledge of business. Indicative content	Mark
4 (c)	AO1 = 3 marks AO2 = 3 marks AO3 = 3 marks AO4 = 3 marks <u>AO1</u> • A franchise is a business that gives the right to another person or business to sell its products or services • The franchise receives set-up /royalty fees from the franchisee <u>AO2</u> • The franchisees can assist in the growth of <i>Ocean Vibes</i> by offering boat tours in other tourist resorts • <i>Ocean Vibes</i> will receive revenue from the franchisees operating in other tourist resorts in Portugal <u>AO3</u> • This will allow the brand name of <i>Ocean Vibes</i> to be extended to other areas of Portugal and encourage customer loyalty • The fees received by <i>Ocean Vibes</i> can be used to invest in the research of wildlife to fulfil the goal of Alfred and Pedro which is to connect tourism with science	

	<u>AO4</u> • However, <i>Ocean Vibes</i> risk the chance of their reputation being damaged if the franchisees do not operate the boat tours in a responsible manner • However, there are many competitors in the boat tour market and Alfred and Pedro may fail to find franchisees who are willing to pay the franchise fees to <i>Ocean Vibes</i>	(12)
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Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1-4	• Demonstrates elements of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues, with limited business terminology used. (AO1) • Limited application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context. (AO2) • Attempts to deconstruct business information and/or issues, finding limited connections between points. (AO3) • Makes a judgement, providing a simple justification based on limited evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)
Level 2	5 - 8	• Demonstrates mostly accurate knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues including appropriate use of business terminology in places. (AO1) • Sound application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context although there may be some inconsistencies. (AO2) • Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding interconnected points with chains of reasoning, although there may be some logical inconsistencies. (AO3) • Makes a judgement, providing a justification based on sound evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)

Level 3	9 - 12	• Demonstrates accurate knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues throughout, including appropriate use of business terminology. (AO1) • Detailed application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context throughout. (AO2) • Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding detailed interconnected points with logical chains of reasoning. (AO3) • Makes a judgement, providing a clear justification based on a thorough evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)
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